

CVRocket Guest Generation Experience

Design proposal for allowing first-time visitors to generate a tailored resume and cover letter without completing registration or profile setup first.

Primary objective: reduce onboarding friction and let visitors experience CVRocket's core value before asking them to create an account.

1. Recommended product model

The recommended implementation is an **anonymous guest account behind the scenes**, rather than a truly identity-free request. The visitor sees no registration form, but the backend creates a temporary user identity that can own uploads, extracted profile data, generation jobs, and output files.

Suggested lifecycle

Visitor opens the public trial page -> an anonymous user ID is created -> the visitor uploads one resume and supplies one job description -> CVRocket extracts a temporary candidate profile -> the existing generation pipeline runs -> the visitor can download the result -> registration upgrades the same guest identity and preserves the work.

Why this model is preferable

- It avoids duplicate guest and registered ownership models.
- The existing resume, profile, job-description, and generation tables can continue using a user ID.
- The visitor can register after seeing the result without losing files or history.
- Row-level security and download authorization remain straightforward.
- Guest activity can be limited transactionally and audited like normal account activity.

2. Controlling free anonymous attempts

Do not rely on IP address alone. Shared networks create false positives, while VPNs, mobile networks, IPv6 rotation, and private browsing make IP-only controls easy to bypass.

Recommended layered controls

Guest user ID	Primary entitlement owner. Allow one successful guest generation.
Signed device cookie	Stops simple repeat use from the same browser profile.
IP-based velocity limit	Use as a soft abuse signal, not permanent identity.
Human verification	Use Turnstile or equivalent before an expensive generation.
Behavioural checks	Detect unusually fast repeats, concurrent requests, automation, or repeated failures.
Account entitlement	After registration, switch to the normal account-based free or paid limit.

Suggested initial policy

- **Guest:** one complete generation, including resume and cover-letter downloads.
- **Signed device:** one successful guest generation.
- **IP hash:** soft daily limit such as three guest generations per 24 hours, plus a stricter short-term velocity limit.
- **Borderline cases:** request registration rather than permanently blocking the visitor.
- **Failures:** internal parsing or rendering failures should release the reserved guest credit.

Important: the free result should be complete. Hiding downloads until registration would make the trial feel like a signup gate and reduce trust.

3. Guest page design

Create a focused public route such as `/try`. Do not initially place anonymous visitors inside the full dashboard shown on the current Generate page. Dashboard, History, Billing, saved Resume lists, Job Descriptions, and Profile are meaningful only after the user decides to continue.

Proposed page structure

Try CVRocket

Tailor your existing resume to a job in about a minute.

1. Upload your resume

PDF or DOCX

2. Add the job description

Paste text or fetch from URL

3. Generate

Generate tailored resume and cover letter

Design principles

- One primary task per step.
- No saved-resource selectors, credit dashboard, or account navigation.
- Automatically create the temporary candidate profile from the uploaded resume.
- Keep profile review optional; do not force editing before generation.
- Default to the normal/balanced tailoring mode, with an optional compact control for advanced users.
- Show detected resume identity and detected job title/company as immediate confirmation.

Step 1 - Upload resume

After processing, show a compact confirmation such as **Resume processed - Asia Dalakova, Senior Software Engineer**, optionally followed by a summary like **6 roles, 7 years, 24 technical skills detected**.

Suggested privacy copy: *We securely extract your experience and skills to create a temporary candidate profile. You can review or save it after generation.*

Step 2 - Add job description

- Keep both existing options: From URL and Paste text.
- After extraction, display the detected title and company.
- Allow the user to correct extraction problems without leaving the page.

Step 3 - Generate

The main action should be explicit: **Generate tailored resume and cover letter**. At this point the backend verifies the guest entitlement, human-verification token, device token, and abuse limits, then reserves one guest generation before starting the existing pipeline.

4. Result and conversion experience

The guest result page should include:

- Rendered resume preview.
- Resume PDF and DOCX downloads.
- Cover-letter preview and downloads.
- View Changes.
- A clear but non-blocking invitation to create an account.

Your tailored application is ready.

Create a free account to save this resume, edit your profile, access it later, and generate another version.

Primary: Download resume

Secondary: Create free account and save

Registration incentive

Registration should unlock continuity rather than access to the result the visitor already waited for.

Guest	One complete generation and downloads.
Registered free account	Additional free generations, saved history, reusable profile, multiple resumes and job descriptions, and change tracking.

5. Anonymous-to-registered upgrade

When the visitor registers, retain the same anonymous user where possible and attach email/password, magic link, or social login to it. The resume, extracted profile, job description, generated files, and result history remain owned by the same identity.

Upgrade sequence

- Link the chosen permanent login method.
- Mark the user as no longer anonymous.
- Retain all guest-owned data and generated artifacts.
- Assign the registered-account free allowance.
- Redirect to the normal authenticated Generate page with the previous inputs and result already available.

6. Data lifecycle and privacy

- Automatically delete guest uploads and artifacts after 24-72 hours unless the visitor registers.
- Use private storage and signed, expiring download URLs.
- Apply strict owner checks to every artifact request.
- Provide a visible Delete my files now action.
- Explain the retention period near the upload control.
- Store a daily HMAC-derived IP grouping value for abuse detection instead of retaining clear IP addresses indefinitely, where practical.

Suggested copy: Guest files are private and automatically deleted after 24 hours unless you create an account.

7. Backend entitlement model

Reuse the current generation pipeline. Add a guest entitlement and abuse-control layer rather than creating a separate generation implementation.

Illustrative records

```
users
  id, is_anonymous, upgraded_at

generation_entitlements
  user_id, guest_generations_allowed, guest_generations_used, reserved_count

guest_devices
  device_token_hash, first_seen_at, generation_used_at

generation_abuse_events
  user_id, ip_daily_hash, event_type, risk_reason, created_at
```

Atomic credit reservation

Reserve the guest credit in a transaction before starting generation. This prevents two browser tabs from using the same allowance concurrently.

```
BEGIN
lock entitlement row
if used + reserved >= allowed: reject
reserved += 1
COMMIT

On success: reserved -= 1; used += 1
On internal failure: reserved -= 1
```

8. Relationship to the current Generate page

Public /try	One resume upload, one job description, automatic temporary profile, minimal navigation, one guest entitlement.
Authenticated /generate	Stored resumes and job descriptions, existing profile, account credit display, history, billing, and full dashboard navigation.

Both routes should reuse the same upload, extraction, job parsing, generation, rendering, and download components. Only the presentation, ownership state, and entitlement checks differ.

9. Recommended first release

- Supabase anonymous authentication or an equivalent internal guest identity.
- One full guest generation.
- One signed first-party device token.
- Soft IP-based velocity limits.
- Turnstile or equivalent human verification before generation.
- Automatic profile extraction from the uploaded resume.
- Temporary file deletion after 24 hours.
- Full PDF and DOCX downloads without registration.
- Guest-to-account upgrade that preserves all work.

10. What to measure

- Visitor-to-generation-start conversion.
- Generation completion and failure rates.
- Guest result download rate.
- Guest-to-registration conversion after seeing the result.
- Anonymous generation cost per converted account.
- Repeated device and repeated IP frequency.
- Percentage of visitors who open profile review before generation.
- Time from landing on /try to first completed output.

Final recommendation

Ship a separate, simplified public trial page backed by an anonymous user identity. Give the visitor one complete generation, protect it with layered entitlement and abuse controls, and ask for registration only after CVRocket has demonstrated its value. Preserve the guest's work during account upgrade so the transition into the existing dashboard is seamless.